

Testing Plan — Dynamic Stack System

Last updated: 2026-04-28. Updated by Claude at end of each session.

How to use this document: After each playtest, read the decision tree on the next page to find which stack to run next. Pick the stack that addresses the most pressing issue the playtest surfaced. PDFs for all available tests are in their stack folder.

Testing Stacks

A **stack** = a group of 1–3 test scenarios that all push toward the same experience outcome. Stacks are independent — run them in any order based on what the game needs most.

Stack	Outcome	Scenarios in Stack	Status
A	Make cleverness rewarding	L2-G1: Attack nerf · L2-G2: + Combo bonus	Ready — print now
B	Make Guards matter more	L3: Bodyguard fix (defender-only)	Ready — print now
C	Shorten games / accelerate kills	Checkmate win condition · L5: Board + piece count	Not yet written
D	Optimise board feel	8×8 board · Hex grid (needs / research first)	Not yet written
E	Improve drafting experience	Pool draft (OQ-35) · Placement order (OQ-36+48)	Not yet written
F	More levers for clever plays	OQ-51: Cascade trigger · Positional payoff · Ultimate skills	Not yet written
G	Radical structure redesign	Unified AP framework (no separate Movement/Action phases)	Draft written — not yet tested

Stacks Ready to Print Now

File	Contents	Stack
stack-a-cleverness/stack-a-game1-attack-nerf.pdf	Standard attack 1 DMG. Play FIRST.	A
stack-a-cleverness/stack-a-game2-attack-nerf-combo.pdf	Same + multi-Champion combo bonus. Play SECOND.	A
stack-a-cleverness/stack-a-feedback.pdf	Feedback form — fill out after both Stack A games.	A
stack-b-guards/stack-b-bodyguard-fix.pdf	Bodyguard adjacency: defender only.	B
stack-b-guards/stack-b-feedback.pdf	Feedback form — fill out after Stack B.	B
shared/game-tracking.pdf	Per-player in-game tracking sheet. Print 1 per player per game.	—

Entry Conditions Per Stack

Stack	When to enter
A	Always first — foundation for all other stacks. Results drive most downstream decisions.
B	Any time. Independent of Stack A combat results. Run whenever Guard utility feels low.
C	If first Champion kill is still past Round 20 after Stack A. Checkmate layer is independent. Board/piece count waits for L2+L3 kill data.

Stack	When to enter
D	If Stack A + B data shows board size as bottleneck. Hex variant gated on running /research hex vs square grid first.
E	After Stack B (Layer 3) is accepted. Independent of combat system.
F	After Stack A combo bonus data is in. Dependent on whether combo ceiling still feels low.

Decision Tree

After each playtest, follow the branch that matches your result to find the highest-value next stack.



Figure 1: Dynamic testing decision tree. Update this diagram after each session.

Accepted Layers (Carry Forward Into All Future Sheets)

Layer	Status	What it adds
1: Economy fix	Accepted (Playtest 2, 24.04.2026)	6 start Runes · +2/turn · +1 every 5 rounds

All future layers must include Layer 1 economy values. Use `section-setup(start-runes: 6, layer1-accepted: true)` and `section-resource-economy(start-runes: 6, layer1-accepted: true)` in `baseline-sections.typ`.

How to Create a New Test Layer

1. Identify which stack the new layer belongs to.
2. Create folder: `docs/test-scenarios/layer-N-<stack-slug>/`
3. Write `layer-N-<desc>.typ` — import `baseline-sections.typ`, call section functions with only the changed parameters.
4. Write `layer-N-feedback.typ` — copy `shared/feedback-baseline.typ`, fill `[LAYER: ...]` placeholders, add OQ-monitoring questions for this layer's active OQs.
5. Add both files to `build-pdfs.sh`.
6. Update this TESTING_PLAN.typ: add the new scenario to the stack table and decision tree.
7. Run `zsh docs/test-scenarios/build-pdfs.sh` to compile.